Intellectual Merit Criterion

Overall Assessment of Intellectual Merit
Very Good

Explanation to Applicant
Overall the proposal is well-articulated - both the rationale and how it will be carried out. Some details are missing which would have helped to clarify. The student has a relatively weak early academic performance though the rationale was explained and more recent academic performance highlights the potential the candidate has for success.

Broader Impacts Criterion

Overall Assessment of Broader Impacts
Excellent

Explanation to Applicant
The candidate articulates their past challenges clearly and how they have overcome diversity, and how they plan to leverage that to impact other individuals who face similar challenges.

Summary Comments
This is a overall a strong application from a candidate who has had to overcome personal disabilities as well as financial and academic challenges, and yet persisted in their track and articulates a clear vision for giving back and impacting the community. The proposal overall is well written.

Intellectual Merit Criterion

Overall Assessment of Intellectual Merit
Excellent

Explanation to Applicant
Strengths - The applicant has compelling research and academic experience, working in 2 research labs, and earning/writing 4 competitive scholarships, 3 fellowships, 1 co-author publication, 2 abstracts. - Th applicant explained importance of and rationale behind their past and proposed research well, demonstrating a clear progression in their scientific training. - Well-structured research statement with clear aims, goals, design, and anticipated results Weaknesses - none noted.

Broader Impacts Criterion

Overall Assessment of Broader Impacts
Excellent

Explanation to Applicant
Strengths - The applicant has done, and continues to do, outreach with organizations that will increase accessibility for blind and low vision students in science, solving a critical, unmet need, that has clear potential to transform how and who does science. - Teaching experience in research lab, and as instructor in undergrad course - The applicant's participation in research will increase diversity in science Weaknesses - none noted.

Summary Comments
Overall, this applicant has clear potential to positively impact neuroscience research with their research and outreach. The

application has an exceptionally well-developed and described proposed research and outstanding broader impacts of both the research and applicant's extensive outreach.

Intellectual Merit Criterion

Overall Assessment of Intellectual Merit

Excellent

Explanation to Applicant

Highly motivated non-traditional applicant who has pursued science despite many challenges and obstacles. Diverse academic and industry experiences that have added to the unique repertoire of tools and techniques. Lucid presentation of a well-designed and thought-out research plan. Experimental design is straightforward, and the availability of preliminary data demonstrates feasibility. Solid letters of support from industry and academic advisers attest to the applicant's ability to quickly grasp advanced concepts. Strong presentation skills are also highlighted

Broader Impacts Criterion

Overall Assessment of Broader Impacts

Excellent

Explanation to Applicant

The lessons learned by the applicant's impairment are highly noteworthy. Utilizing this perspective to make life better for several others would make for a noble societal and scientific contribution. The plan to develop tactile learning kits by 3D printing is outstanding and will break barriers for many with similar impairments

Summary Comments

This is an outstanding applicant who has overcome major obstacles and challenges stemming from visual impairment. The progress made in the face of challenges is truly commendable. The combination of industry and academic experience is noteworthy. The goal and concrete plans to uplift those with similar impairment is remarkable.